

Accessible SVG Icon System Report

Parker Woolsey

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Site Details

My live accessible SVG icon page is at <https://pwoolls1.github.io/WDD331R/resume.html> and the source code is at <https://pwoolls1.github.io/WDD331R/>.

Reflection

Write a thoughtful response to each prompt. These are not summaries of what you did. They ask you to reason about why your icon and accessibility choices work the way they do on a real page.

Page Choice and Integration

I added the accessible SVG icon system to my Resume/CV page. This page was the best candidate because it already contained several clearly defined sections, including education, technical skills, professional experience, projects, and volunteer service. Each section had a natural connection to a recognizable icon, so the icons improved scanning without feeling unnecessary or decorative for their own sake.

I placed one hidden inline SVG sprite as the first element inside the page's `<body>`. The sprite stores each Lucide icon as a reusable `<symbol>`, and the visible icons reference those symbols with `<use>`. This kept the HTML more consistent because I did not need to repeat the complete path data every time an icon appeared.

I integrated the icons into elements that already existed instead of restructuring the resume around them. A house icon was added to the existing Back Home button. The Education, Technical Skills, Professional Experience, Projects, and Volunteer Service headings received icons that visually represent their content. I also added a GitHub icon-only link beside the WDD 331R Practice Site project. The page kept its original sections, content, and order, while the icons added visual organization and made important areas easier to identify.

Icon Accessibility and Contrast

I added the following Lucide icons:

House: The house icon appears inside the Back Home button. It uses `aria-hidden="true"` and `focusable="false"` because the visible words "Back Home" already give the link an accessible name. Announcing the icon separately would repeat information.

Graduation Cap: The graduation-cap icon appears beside the Education heading. It is decorative because the heading text already identifies the section. The SVG uses `aria-hidden="true"` and `focusable="false"`.

Code 2: The code-2 icon appears beside the Technical Skills heading. It uses the decorative pattern because "Technical Skills" communicates the meaning of the section without assistance from the icon.

Briefcase Business: The briefcase-business icon appears beside the Professional Experience heading. It is hidden from assistive technology because it supports the visible heading rather than adding new information.

Folder Code: The folder-code icon appears beside the Projects heading. It uses the decorative pattern because the visible word "Projects" already provides the necessary meaning.

Heart Handshake: The heart-handshake icon appears beside the Volunteer Service heading. It is decorative and uses `aria-hidden="true"` and `focusable="false"` because the heading text provides the section label.

GitHub: The GitHub icon appears as an icon-only link beside the WDD 331R Practice Site project. Because it does not include visible text, the link has an `aria-label` that identifies its purpose as a link to the project's GitHub repository. The SVG itself remains hidden with `aria-hidden="true"` so the accessible name comes from the link rather than the icon.

I checked the icons in Chrome DevTools by opening the Rendering panel and changing the emulated `prefers-color-scheme` setting between light and dark. The icons use `stroke="currentColor"`, so they inherit the color of their heading, button, or link. This allowed them to change automatically when the site's color tokens changed between themes.

I did not find a contrast problem in either mode. The heading icons inherited the same readable text color as their headings, while the Back Home and GitHub icons inherited the colors of their interactive elements. Because I avoided fixed black or white stroke values, the icons remained visible against both light and dark backgrounds. I also inspected the icon-only GitHub link in the Accessibility panel and confirmed that its computed accessible name came from the `aria-label`.

